

Sports

Centro Linguistico di Ateneo
Excellence in Linguistic Training



Grammar Focus	Topic Focus
The Passive Voice	Sports
Conditionals Zero Conditional Type 1 Conditional	Sports Injuries & Accidents Sports Locations
If & Unless	Sports Equipment
Linking Words	

Centro Linguistico di Ateneo
Excellence in Linguistic Training

The Passive Voice

Difference between Active and Passive Verbs

When we use an active verb, we say *what the subject does*:

- My grandfather **built** this house. **He built** it in 1964. (My grandfather, the subject, **performs the action** - **ACTIVE**)

When we use the passive verb, we say *what happens to the subject*:

- The house **was built** in 1964. (The house, the subject, **experiences the action – PASSIVE**)

- I **eat** the apple (ACTIVE)
- The apple **is eaten** by me (PASSIVE)

The passive voice is used to show interest in the person or object that **experiences an action** rather than the person or object that **performs the action**. In other words**, the most important thing or person becomes the subject of the sentence**.

The Passive Voice

Examples

- The passive voice **is used** frequently. (= we are interested in the passive voice, not in who uses it.)
- The table **was built** in 1654. (= we are interested in the table, not in who built it.)
- The building **is being repaired**. (= we are interested in the building, not in the people who are doing the repairs.)

Sometimes we use the passive voice because we don't know, or do not want to express, who performed the action.

Examples

- I noticed that the door **had been left** open.
- Every year thousands of animals **are killed** by hunters.
- All the peaches **have been eaten**.
- My wallet **has been stolen**!

The Passive Voice

The passive voice is often used in **formal texts**. Changing to the active voice will make your writing clearer and easier to read.

Passive	**Active**
This room is cleaned every day	Somebody cleans this room every day
Many accidents are caused by dangerous driving	Dangerous driving causes many accidents
We were woken up by a loud noise	A loud noise woke us up
All flights were cancelled because of the fog	They cancelled all flights because of the fog
How are languages learnt?	How do people learn languages?

If we want to say **who** or **what** performs the action, we use the Passive Voice with the preposition **BY.**

Passive	**Active**
"Yesterday" was written **by** The Beatles	The Beatles wrote "Yesterday"
The film "The Gladiator" was directed **by** Ridley Scott	Ridley Scott directed the film "The Gladiator"
This house was built **by** my grandfather	My grandfather built this house

The Passive Voice

We make the passive by putting the verb 'to be' into whatever tense we need and then adding the Past Participle. For regular verbs, we make the past participle by adding 'ed' to the bare infinitive. For irregular verbs, it is the 3rd column of the Irregular Verbs list. Therefore: Subject + the conjugated form of BE + Past Participle.

Tense	Active	Passive
Present Simple	I make a cake.	A cake is made (by me).
Present Continuous	I am making a cake.	A cake is being made (by me).
Past Simple	I made a cake.	A cake was made (by me).
Past Continuous	I was making a cake.	A cake was being made (by me).
Present Perfect	I have made a cake.	A cake has been made (by me).
Present Perfect Continuous*	I have been making a cake.	A cake has been being made (by me).
Past Perfect	I had made a cake.	A cake had been made (by me).
Past Perfect Continuous*	I had been making a cake.	A cake had been being made (by me).
Future Simple	I will make a cake.	A cake will be made (by me).

* The Passive is not very common in the Present and Past Perfect Continuous tenses.

The Passive Voice

Passive voice with infinitives
The infinitive passive voice is used after modal verbs and other verbs normally followed by an infinitive.

Active	**Passive**
Somebody **will clean** this room later	This room **will be cleaned** later
You **can't explain** a mystery	A mystery is something that **can't be explained**.
They **might hire** John next week	John **might be hired** next week.

Passive voice with gerunds
The passive of gerunds (*doing/seeing*, etc.) is *being done/being seen*, etc.

Active	**Passive**
I dont' like **my sister telling me** what to do	I don't like **being told** what to do (by my sister)
She hates **people keeping her** waiting	She hates **being kept** waiting (by people)
I remember my **father teaching me** to drive	I remember **being taught** to drive(by my father)
The kids are excited about **us taking them** to the zoo	The kids are excited about **being taken** to the zoo (by us)

The Passive Voice

Using "to be born"
"To be born" is a passive form and is most commonly used in the past tense. However, in some cases, the present or future tense is appropriate.

Examples
- When **were you born**? I **was born** in 1976.
- Where **were you born**? I **was born** in Cambridge.
- Around 100 babies **are born** in this hospital every week.
- We don't know on exactly which day the baby **will be born**.

Get for the Passive
Sometimes the passive is formed using the verb GET instead of the verb BE. We use GET only when things HAPPEN:

Active	**Passive**
I **am not invited** to many parties	I don't **get invited** to many parties

We use GET only when things HAPPEN. You cannot use GET in sentences like this:
Anna **is liked** by everyone (not GETS LIKED – this is not a *happening*)

Conditionals

The **Zero Conditional** is used for when the time being referred to is the **present** (**now**) or **always** and the situation is **real** and **possible**.
The Zero Conditional is often used to refer to **general truths**. The tense in both parts of the sentence is the **simple present**.
In Zero Conditional sentences, the word "if" can usually be replaced by the word "when" without changing the meaning.
The two clauses are separated by a comma (,)

We use the Zero Conditional to speak about natural laws or general truths.
It is formed in the following way:

IF + Subject + Present Simple + , + Present Simple

Example:

If we heat ice, it melts
If you don't water plants regularly, they die
If I eat too much, I gain weight

Conditionals

The **Type 1 Conditional** is used to express something that **will probably happen** in the **future**.
The Type 1 Conditional refers to a **possible condition and its probable result**.
In these sentences the **if clause** is in the **simple present**, and the **main clause** is in the **simple future**.
The two clauses are separated by a comma (,)

We use the Type 1 Conditional to refer to the **present** or **future** when the **situation is real**.
It is formed in the following way:

IF + Subject + Present Simple + , + Future Simple (Will + base form)

Example:

If you don't hurry, you will miss the train
If you don't study enough, you won't pass your exams
If Sarah gets the job, she will move to London

If & Unless

If means **on condition that**, but often, when we are talking about present situations, we use **unless** instead of **if...not**.

Unless simply means **except if** or **if...not / if there isn't / if there aren't**.

Both of these examples have the **same meaning** and refer to the **present time**.
Unless is used with an affirmative verb, while **if** is used with a negative verb.

You can't go on vacation **unless** you **save** some money.
If you **don't save** some money, you can't go on vacation.

You will feel cold **if** you **don't wear** a coat.
You will feel cold **unless** you **wear** a coat.

Mark will fail his exam, **unless** he **studies**.
Mark will fail his exam, **if** he **doesn't study**.

Linking Words

Linking words help you to connect ideas and sentences when you speak or write English. We can use linking words to give examples, add information, summarise, sequence information, give a reason or result, or to contrast ideas.
Here's a list of the most common linking words and phrases:

Giving examples

The most common way to **give examples** is by using **for example** or **for instance**.

- There are many ways to improve your English. **For example**, by watching English films.
- I have many dreams. **For instance**, I would love to go to the Arctic Circle to see the polar bears!

Namely refers to something by name.

- There are two issues: **namely**, the time and the cost.

Adding information

You can use many linking words to **add information:**

And	**In addition**	**As well as**	**Also**	**Too**
Furthermore	**Moreover**	**Apart from**	**In addition to**	**Besides**

Ideas are often linked by **and**. In a list, you put a comma between each item, but not before **and**.

- We discussed about music, literature **and** art.

Linking Words

Adding information

Also is used to add an extra idea or emphasis.
- We **also** spoke about science.

You can use **also** with **not only** to give emphasis.
- We were interested **not only** in the film's screenplay, but **also** in the characters.

We don't usually start a sentence with **also**. If you want to start a sentence with a phrase that means **also**, you can use **In addition,** or **In addition to this…**
- **In addition to** the film's screenplay, we were interested in the characters.

As well as can be used at the beginning or in the middle of a sentence.
- **As well as** in the film's screenplay, we were **also** interested in the characters.
- We were **also** interested in the characters, **as well as** in the film's screenplay.

Too goes either at the end of the sentence, or after the subject and means **as well**.
- They were interested **too**.
- I, **too**, was interested.

Linking Words

Adding information

Apart from and **besides** are often used to mean **as well as**, or **in addition to**.

- **Apart from** Manchester United, we are the oldest British football team.
- **Besides** Manchester United, we are the oldest British football team.

Moreover and **furthermore** add extra information to the point you are making.

- Rowing is one of the classical British sports. **Moreover**, it's good for you!

Summarising

In short **In brief** **In summary**
To summarise **In a nutshell** **To conclude** **In conclusion**

We normally use these words at the **beginning of the sentence** to give a **summary** of what we have said or written.

- **In conclusion**, we have decided that the football match will have to be postponed.

Linking Words

Sequencing ideas

The former… the latter **Firstly, secondly, finally** **The first point is**
Lastly **The following**

The former and **the latter** are useful when you want to refer to one of two points. **The former** is the first point, and **the latter** is the last point.

- English Linguistics and Philology are both studied in this course. **The former** is studied in the first term and **the latter** is studied in the final term.

Firstly, … secondly, … finally (or **lastly**) are useful ways to list ideas.
It's rare to use "fourthly", or "fifthly". Instead, try **the first point**, **the second point**, **the third point** and so on.

The following is a good way of starting a list.

- The following people have been chosen to go on the training course: E. Cooper, T. Ranson, L. Johnston

Linking Words

Giving a reason

Due to / due to the fact that
Because of

Owing to / owing to the fact that
Since

Because
As

Due to and **owing to** must be followed by a **noun**.

- **Due to** the rise in tuitions, the number of students has decreased by 10 per cent.
- **Owing to** the strike, we are unable to deliver the items within the week.

If you want to follow these words with a clause (a subject, verb and object), you must follow the words with **the fact that**.

- **Due to the fact that** tuitions have gone up, the number of students has decreased by 10 per cent.
- **Owing to the fact that** there has been a strike, we are unable to deliver the items within the week.

Because / because of
Because of is followed by a **noun**.

- **Because of** bad weather, the football match was postponed.

Because can be used at the beginning or in the middle of a sentence. For example,

- **Because** it was raining, the match was postponed.
- The match was postponed **because** it was raining.

Linking Words

Giving a reason

Since / as
Since and **as** mean **because**.

- **Since** it is raining, the football match will be postponed.
- **As** it is raining, the football match will be postponed.

Giving a result

Therefore **So** **Consequently** **This means that** **As a result**

Therefore, **so**, **consequently** and **as a result** are all used in a similar way. **So** is more informal.

- It is raining. **Therefore / So / Consequently / As a result**, the football match will be postponed.
- I haven't studied much. **This means that** I will probably fail my English grammar test.

Linking Words

Contrasting ideas

But	**However**	**Although / even though**	**Despite / despite the fact that**
In spite of / in spite of the fact that		**Nevertheless**	**Nonetheless**
While	**Whereas**	**Unlike**	**In theory… in practice…**

But is more informal than **however**. It is not normally used at the beginning of a sentence.

- He works hard, **but** he doesn't do very well in school.
- He works hard. **However**, he doesn't do very well in school.

Although, **despite** and **in spite of** introduce an idea of contrast. With these words, you must have two halves of a sentence.

- **Although** it was cold, she went out in shorts.
- **In spite of** the cold, she went out in shorts.

Despite and **in spite of** are used in the same way as **due to** and **owing to**. They must be followed by a **noun**. If you want to follow them with a **noun and a verb**, you must use **the fact that.**

- **Despite the fact that** it was cold, he went swimming.

Nevertheless and **nonetheless** mean **in spite of that** or **anyway**.

- The sea was cold, but he went swimming **nevertheless**.(In spite of the fact that it was cold.)
- The sea was cold. **Nonetheless**, he went swimming.

Linking Words

Contrasting ideas

While, **whereas** and **unlike** are used to show how two things are different from each other.

- **While** my sister has green eyes, mine are brown.
- Salaries have gone down, **whereas** prices have gone up.
- **Unlike** in the USA, sports are not very promoted in Italian schools.

In theory… in practice… show an unexpected result.

- **In theory**, students should study for their exams, but **in practice**, they often don't have enough time.